

Nikos Vasileiadis

Software Engineering Manager · Leeds, UK (GMT — same timezone as Ireland) · British & Greek (EU)

Citizen

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About Me

I started building websites as a teenager in northern Greece and turned a hobby into a 20-year career. After a decade of freelancing, teaching adults to use computers, and organising open-source conferences, I moved to Leeds in 2015 and found my way into engineering leadership — first through UX and Agile, then through platform teams and people management.

I'm currently an Engineering Manager at Utility Warehouse (FTSE 250), a UK multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile, and insurance — where I run platform services for the company's main website and lead a specialist engineering team. What I've learned across those years — working across financial services, regulated utilities, global retail, and public sector — is that the work I care most about is creating the conditions where people do their best work — through clarity, trust, and genuine investment in their growth.

Greek (EU) citizen — full right to work in Ireland and across the EU. Based in Leeds, same timezone as Dublin. Open to remote roles with Irish organisations.

What I'm About

- **People and teams** — keeping people, growing them, and getting out of their way. 100% retention across three company restructurings. 3 promotions I built the cases for — backed by DORA data. Heartbeat surveys for team wellbeing. I measure what matters and act on it.
- **Platform operations** — keeping critical services running and stakeholders supported across 15+ engineering teams.
- **Design systems** — from co-building an open-source design system to leading enterprise-wide adoption across 20 teams.
- **Commercial sense** — CapEx/OpEx planning, vendor evaluation, and making sure engineering work connects to business outcomes.
- **Documentation** — I inherited undocumented systems and built a culture of writing things down. Over 100 articles and counting.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

Jul 2023 – Present · United Kingdom · Remote

I manage the platform and content engineering team — the people responsible for uw.co.uk and the services that sit behind it. At peak we were 8 engineers across two teams; after three rounds of company restructuring, we're now a specialist core of 2. Everyone who wanted to stay, stayed. Nobody left by choice.

What the team and I have done:

- **Kept people and grew them.** Supported 3 promotions (Associate → Mid, Mid → Senior) with evidence-based cases. Several people I mentored have since moved into Engineering Manager

roles, both inside and outside UW. The 100% retention wasn't luck — it was the result of giving people clarity, trust, and genuine career investment.

- **Measured what mattered.** I started with manual team health tracking (TeamRetro) and custom DORA dashboards before the company rolled out DX. Now I use deployment frequency, lead time, change failure rate, and MTTR to understand delivery health — and that data directly feeds into promotion cases and bonus decisions. Alongside that, monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys tell me how the team is actually doing — and I act on it. Performance isn't just throughput; it's whether people are in a position to sustain it.
- **Navigated restructurings.** When the organisation restructured — three times — I took responsibility for working out where the team should sit: mapping scope, talking to stakeholders, and building consensus. It wasn't in my job description; it needed doing.
- **Fought for what mattered.** When one restructuring would have dissolved the Design Systems team, I pushed back and made the case for keeping it. That team went on to enable the company-wide rebrand.
- **Built a documentation culture from nothing.** We inherited a CMS that nobody had documented in years. I started by mapping what existed — we called it "Archaeology" — and built up from there. Over 100 articles of process and technical documentation now, from architecture decisions to onboarding guides.
- **Upskilled the team.** When we needed Kubernetes knowledge, I learned it first, trained the team, and documented it. I encouraged engineers to present at cross-team forums, own RFCs, and share what they knew — so they could operate independently across the full stack.
- **Hired well.** Involved in hiring 3 external engineers and bringing in 4 through internal transfers — from candidate assessment through to onboarding.
- **Delivered a company-wide rebrand (Oct 2025 – Apr 2026).** The team shipped the brand refresh across 522 pages of the uw.co.uk estate — the main website, the partner portal, the customer account system. We were the critical path: nobody else's rebrand work could go live until ours shipped. We wrote automated migration scripts that saved content editors hundreds of hours of manual work.
- **Kept the platform running.** 100% uptime on uw.co.uk (SLO: 99.99%), <3s page loads on critical pages, 1 incident this year (resolved within hours). The estate includes 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, 1,090 shortlinks, and 218 redirects. We support 8 content teams (33 users) and 15+ engineering teams who depend on the platform. I'm responsible for six platform services — Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, and OneTrust — monitored through Kubernetes, Sentry, Prometheus, Pingdom, and Cloudflare.
- **Led Design System adoption.** The Hearth Design System reached 20 engineering and product teams (15 full, 5 partial). Consolidating components at that level removed thousands of hours of duplicated engineering effort across the organisation. I also helped with R&D tax credit claims by translating the technical work into documentation that external advisors could audit.
- **Replaced the CMS.** The old CMS had no SLA, no SSO, and a dead tech stack. I ran a 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors, shortlisted to 3, and we went with Contentful. The migration was zero-disruption; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained content scheduling, structured models, and no more duplicated content.
- **Kept going with a small team.** When restructurings reduced us to 2 engineers, I absorbed Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside my management role. We continued to deliver across 6 platform services with 100% uptime and full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

Lead Software Engineer

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 — multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)

May 2022 – Jul 2023 · United Kingdom · Remote

I joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing — no department, no established processes, no documentation. It was built to make use of my cross-functional experience in engineering, UX, and delivery.

- Grew the team from 3 to 6+ through hiring and internal transfers. The team survived three company-wide restructurings — each time under a different name (Marketing Capability → Content Capability → CMS Team), but always delivering.
- Set up a Scrum environment from scratch — structured backlog, predictable delivery, filling Product Manager gaps when needed. Mapped the legacy CMS through systematic discovery and wrote the team's foundational documentation.
- Led the vendor evaluation that resulted in UW adopting Contentful as its enterprise CMS.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

IMA-HOME

Jan 2020 – Apr 2022 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Combined frontend architecture with Scrum Master responsibilities for global clients including Adidas and MARS.

- Introduced Agile practices to an agency that had been running entirely on ad-hoc, fire-driven delivery. The result was measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos — a step change in how the team worked.
- Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's (MARS) global web presence — a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support.

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)

Oct 2018 – Jan 2020 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society — a regulated financial services environment — while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- Introduced Agile and Scrum to the organisation for the first time — shifting from ad-hoc output to sprint-based delivery with measurable velocity. I was the primary driver for Agile adoption across the department throughout my time there.
- Appointed as Interim Scrum Master (Jun–Oct 2019) to stabilise delivery during their Digital Transformation programme, working alongside external consultants and cross-functional teams.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Jadu

Jan 2017 – Oct 2018 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by UK Local Authorities, universities, and third-sector organisations. Everything was built with accessibility and W3C standards as non-negotiables.

- Co-created **Pulsar** — an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is where my design systems specialism started, and I'm still proud of it.
- Owned the full feature lifecycle — going out to council offices and universities for contextual research, writing up findings, building mockups, running usability tests, and shipping to production. One of three product-area leads, each responsible for their own domain.

- Gained hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

Early Career, Teaching & Community

Oct 2005 – Dec 2016 (11 years)

The foundation years — where the technical skills, the community instinct, and the career itself all started.

- **Web development & freelancing (2005–2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally — from local non-profits and bands to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed end-to-end client relationships, set up proper billing structures (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed teams. Started at 15 with my first website; bought my first domain in 2005.
- **Teaching & mentorship (2006–2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional qualification and spent a year teaching ECDL to adult learners. Privately tutored a student in programming and hardware — that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and now works as an engineer at Sophos. One of my proudest outcomes.
- **Community & civic technology (2008–2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a national volunteer-powered conference), and managed the digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, and community organisations. This community work directly shaped everything I went on to do in Leeds — GDG, IxDF, NUX.
- **UK agency work (2015–2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Built responsive e-commerce for global brands (Vivienne Westwood) and focused on frontend performance.

Community & Volunteering

Community organising has been a constant throughout my career — from Greece to Leeds.

Mentor, WRK digital (Feb 2023–Present): Mentoring engineers who have gone on to become Engineering Managers. Part of a peer network that spans EMs, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code (Aug–Jan 2024): Supported people making their first steps into the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds (Jan 2019–Mar 2020): Revived an inactive chapter and ran conferences, workshops, and meetups. The highlight was a one-day conference in November 2019 with UK and international speakers — entirely volunteer-powered.

Education

International University of Greece — Serres Campus

BSc Informatics Engineering (attended 2007–2012; strong grades in software engineering, programming, and databases; did not graduate due to the Greek economic crisis and systemic university barriers)

Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026

Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023

Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022–2023

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list available on the [Credentials](#) page.